5.9 CARE OF THE NAIL AND FEET

5.9.1 Characteristics of a healthy nail

A normal healthy nail is transparent, smooth and convex with pink nail beds and translucent white tips.





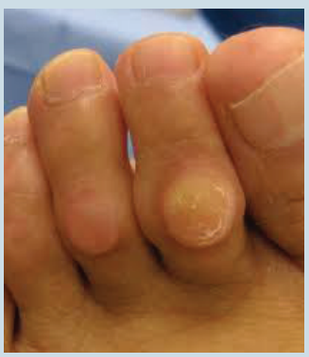
5.9.2 Purposes of care of the nails

1) To keep nails harmless.
2) To prevent accumulation of dirt under the nails and reduce occurrence of infection.

5.9.3 Risk factors for foot and nail ailments

1) Patients with peripheral vascular disease eg. Diabetes mellitus.
2) Patients with neuropathy. (degeneration of peripheral nerves characterized by loss of sensation)
3) Poor ill fitting foot wear.
4) Poor knowledge of foot and nail care.

5.9.4 Common foot and nail problems

Foot and nail problems	Images
1. ***Callus:*** It is a thickened portion of epidermis caused by local friction or pressure.	
2. ***Corns:*** It is caused by friction and pressure from shoes. It is seen mainly on toes, over bonyprominence.	

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